PAWS PARTNERS

Technique Hintbook

v0.2.6 / English

Open this book when you feel close to an answer but cannot quite bring both friends home.

It contains no stage solutions, passwords, or correct WAIT values. Choose a heading and open just the small hint first. If an idea comes to you, return to the game without reading further.

The in-game Up-key hint places a solution chip at the selected spot. This book offers a gentler alternative when you want to work out the answer yourself.

I do not know where to start

A small hint

Look just outside each home, not only at the starting positions.

One step further

Ask where the friend must stand, and which way it must face, immediately before entering its home. Work backward one step at a time. A gate or hole on that route tells you something that must happen first.

You do not have to plan both complete journeys at once. Start by identifying one friend's final job.

There are too many places to put chips

A small hint

Empty is a choice. You do not have to fill every placement spot.

One step further

Follow what would happen if the friend kept walking straight. Leave the spot empty in your plan until you find a reason to turn or wait.

MIN is a reference, not a limit. You can find a working route first and remove unnecessary chips afterward.

TURN sends a friend in an unexpected direction

A small hint

Think of right and left from the walking friend's point of view, not the screen's.

A direction-only exercise

This is a small exercise, not a campaign layout. Imagine entering the same right TURN while walking toward screen-right, then while walking toward screen-left. Would you leave in the same direction?

Point a finger along each incoming direction and rotate it 90 degrees to its own right. A shared chip can produce different outgoing directions for the two friends. Fixed arrows painted on paths and orange arrow floors instead send a friend in the direction shown; they are different from TURN chips.

Only one friend gets home

A small hint

What still needs to change for the other friend to continue?

One step further

Name one missing job: opening a gate, for example, or making a crossing usable. Ask who can do that job and whether they can reach it before going home.

A friend that has arrived home cannot come back to help. Going to the nearest home first is not always the right plan for both friends.

I do not know where to push a crate

A small hint

Compare the paths and mechanisms before and after the push.

One step further

Look at the place the crate leaves as well as its destination. Moving it may clear a path or remove the weight from a PAD.

A crate dropped into a hole becomes a bridge and can no longer be pushed. Check whether you might need that crate for something else later.

A gate opens, but later someone gets stuck

A small hint

Does this gate stay open after OPEN is pressed, or is it an A gate that needs a PAD to remain held?

An I or II gate changes whenever SWAP is pressed. Identify the gate type first.

One step further

Check whether the gate stays open until the friend needs to pass, not just whether it opens once. What changes when the friend holding the PAD moves again?

One action may also release a waiting friend. Watch that friend as well as the gate.

SWAP closes one group while opening the other. Check both the immediate next step and the passages needed later.

Changing WAIT does not help

A small hint

Before changing the number, decide what you are waiting for.

One step further

Write a short ordering such as “the other friend reaches a place → this friend reaches a junction.” Is the order wrong, or is a necessary job never happening at all?

WAIT pauses a friend at that spot, then lets it continue in the same direction. Waiting after a direction-setting floor cannot undo a direction already chosen. Check the waiting place as well as the duration.

The same place behaves differently on another visit

A small hint

Has the incoming direction, a crate, a hole, a gate, or an arrow changed?

One step further

Label the visits “first” and “second,” then consider the arrival state separately. Visiting the same place does not necessarily mean the same thing will happen.

For a FLIP-controlled arrow, its direction when the friend arrives matters. Placed TURN and WAIT chips act again on a later visit.

Distinguish a square that is stepped on from one that is jumped over. The placements may be unchanged, but whether a friend lands there matters.

I have lost track of what I tried

A small hint

Choose one prediction and test it instead of changing everything at once.

A note before trying

This example is not tied to any campaign stage.

Change	Prediction	Observed result	Next question
Move the waiting spot	Move after the other friend passes	Moved before the other friend passed	Is a different wait or route needed?

Keep working parts temporarily and investigate the first point where reality differs from your prediction. Be willing to revisit them: something that succeeds early may cause a later problem.

What should I check when crossing a switch twice?

SWAP changes the state every time; ONCE acts only on its first use. Trace the outward and return journeys separately and ask whether the switch will still act on the second visit. A USED floor remains walkable.

I cannot keep track of both friends on a large map

Press Enter to pause and observe. While running, the arrow keys change the displayed area; F4 changes the friend you follow.

F5 shows the current positions of both friends and crates, along with gate states. **Execution continues in the overview; press Enter to pause and think.**

If a run differs from your prediction, press Esc to return to the start with your placements retained. You do not need to watch it finish.

At the stuck screen, Enter retries with your placements retained. There is no time limit while you think.

One last thought

Before asking “How can I do this?”, try asking “What would this action make unavailable afterward?”

If no idea comes, note your password and take a break. When you find an answer without opening the next hint, this book has done its job.

Describe the state a gate requires

Before looking for an opening action, describe the condition that opens the gate. At least one, none, and at least two at the same time are different conditions. Include both friends as well as crates when checking what occupies a floor.